

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 8

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Let's continue with **James 1:5–8**. This is Nancy's translation.

⁵But if anyone should find themselves lacking practical skill in situations, let them ask God about it. God generously gives practical help to everyone, and He gives without throwing their dysfunction back in their faces to shame and belittle them. God will give wisdom to the one who asks for skill to deal with situations. ⁶But that person must ask in faith. In other words, they must be ready to act upon what God shows them without any hesitancy or wavering; for the one who wavers is like the surf of the sea, driven and tossed by the wind. ⁷Such persons ought not to imagine that they will receive anything from the Lord, ⁸being double-minded, or of two spirits, and therefore, unstable in all their ways.

Take a deep breath.

1. **Success is often more spiritually unstable than distress**

Remember that for the development of the True Self we need a long-tempered endurance. No matter what happens around you, your primary goal is to develop the long-tempered endurance that will equip you to live your life gloriously. We often think that we need endurance most in times of fear or loss, but that is not always the case. God usually has our attention during what our hymn calls "times of dire distress" and in times of failure. It is in times of success that the quality of our training is revealed—when we get what we want, when we feel euphoric. It is in success that we need to be most mindful and aware. How often have we seen so-called successful people fail to build trustworthy, fulfilled lives?

You might imagine that you will naturally learn to handle success productively and that you will find peace with the new status quo, but this also requires training. Success brings unprecedented experiences and changes that create tension, and this tension causes our Idol Self to react. Your ability to handle success with success is directly proportional to your ability to endure that tension. Let's take as an example the tension that we experience when we are successful in our personal development. For mastery type Christians, to show heartfelt kindness or mercy is success, but in order to maintain this positive direction they must endure the tension that forfeiting an opportunity to punish and conquer will bring. When self-effacing types successfully stand up for themselves or assert their preferences, they must endure the tension of feeling selfish. They must resist the compulsion to give in, please, or apologize. When resigned types successfully touch an area of self-awareness and make some progress toward feeling their real feelings, they must endure the craving to escape into stagnation and numbness. God is regularly seeking to stretch your ability to live gloriously, but He can only do this if you are able to productively endure the tension created by change. God wants to explore with you as,

together, you discover your potential. You are an eternally developing creature who is learning the ways of eternity.

2. The basic problem is our commitment—are we committed to our Idol or to God?

Trusting God's wisdom requires training—training that prepares you to courageously act on the wisdom He offers. God cannot train you, however, if you are still committed to the judgment path; you will refuse to follow through with His way of doing things. But remember this: if you continue to harbor divided loyalties, you are not simply choosing between judgment and love; at the heart of your choice is this question—*Who is your God?*

When we are committed to our Idol Self, we are committed to another god, and if we obey the fear and compulsive demands of the Idol, we are obeying another god. It's not hard to see that the Idol Self is just another god. So, whenever we follow the Idol's guidance, we are breaking God's first commandment: "Thou shalt have no other gods before Me." When God confronts that problem in you, He is doing you a huge favor.

3. Two spirits are two masters

When we are torn between two masters, our instability becomes readily apparent, even to ourselves. We are not to be trusted. We talk about being a Christian, but neither the quality of our words nor our lives reflect that glorious new birth. We have not yet agreed within ourselves that God is who He says He is—the Creator and only Lawgiver and Judge. We are not convinced that opposing Him has real consequences. We would rather gratify our pride than access and enjoy God as our ally.

4. Karis Fellowships teaches us tools that help us become single-spirit people

This is another way of describing our goal in KF: we are working toward becoming *single-spirit* people. No one can serve two masters. If you find that your life is full of unstable habits and relationships, if you make decisions and then refuse to follow through, if you commit to training and then refuse to train, or if you have taken the name of Christian but choose to do your own thing, then you are like the waves of the surf, which the winds of circumstances and feelings toss back and forth. Would you put your trust in that kind of sea? Would you trust that kind of person?

Hopefully, you are now willing to recognize this temptation to serve two masters. You might tell God this week that you are ready to give up trying to be god and willing to train your woefully underdeveloped True Self. When you give up the life of being your own god and doing your own thing, you will be free to pursue your real potential as a glorious creature in karis relationship with the real God, who is love. This love is beyond all that you can ask or think, but it is not beyond what you can experience.

Our prayer might go something like this:

God and Creator, I am ready to be Your creature in karis relationship. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week and help us to reorient our lives to a more effective flow, to furthering our connection with our True Self and design, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.